HOW TO AI

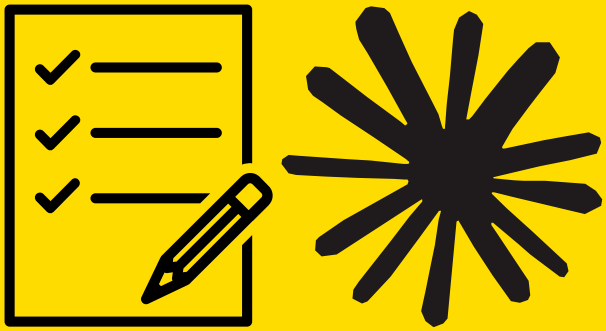
IKEA TYPE INSTRUCTIONS

01

HOW TO START WITH CLAUDE:

(written as IKEA instructions)

The complete Claude setup.
Step by step. In pictures.

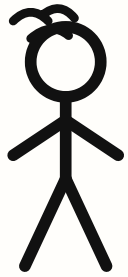


12 STEPS · 1 AFTERNOON · Free

Ruben Hassid · How to AI

READ THIS FIRST

Before you begin.



✗

Do not guess.



!

One model here is pay-per-use.

Step 6 covers when to use it - and when not to.



✓

Stuck? Type ELI5

Claude explains it like you're five.

Total time: one afternoon.

PARTS LIST

What you need.

Check the box before you start. Nothing here is missing.

- [ ] **1×** claude.ai account
- [ ] **2×** models - daily & hard
- [ ] **1×** magic sentence (step 3)
- [ ] **1×** Project (steps 7–8)
- [ ] **8×** copy-paste prompts

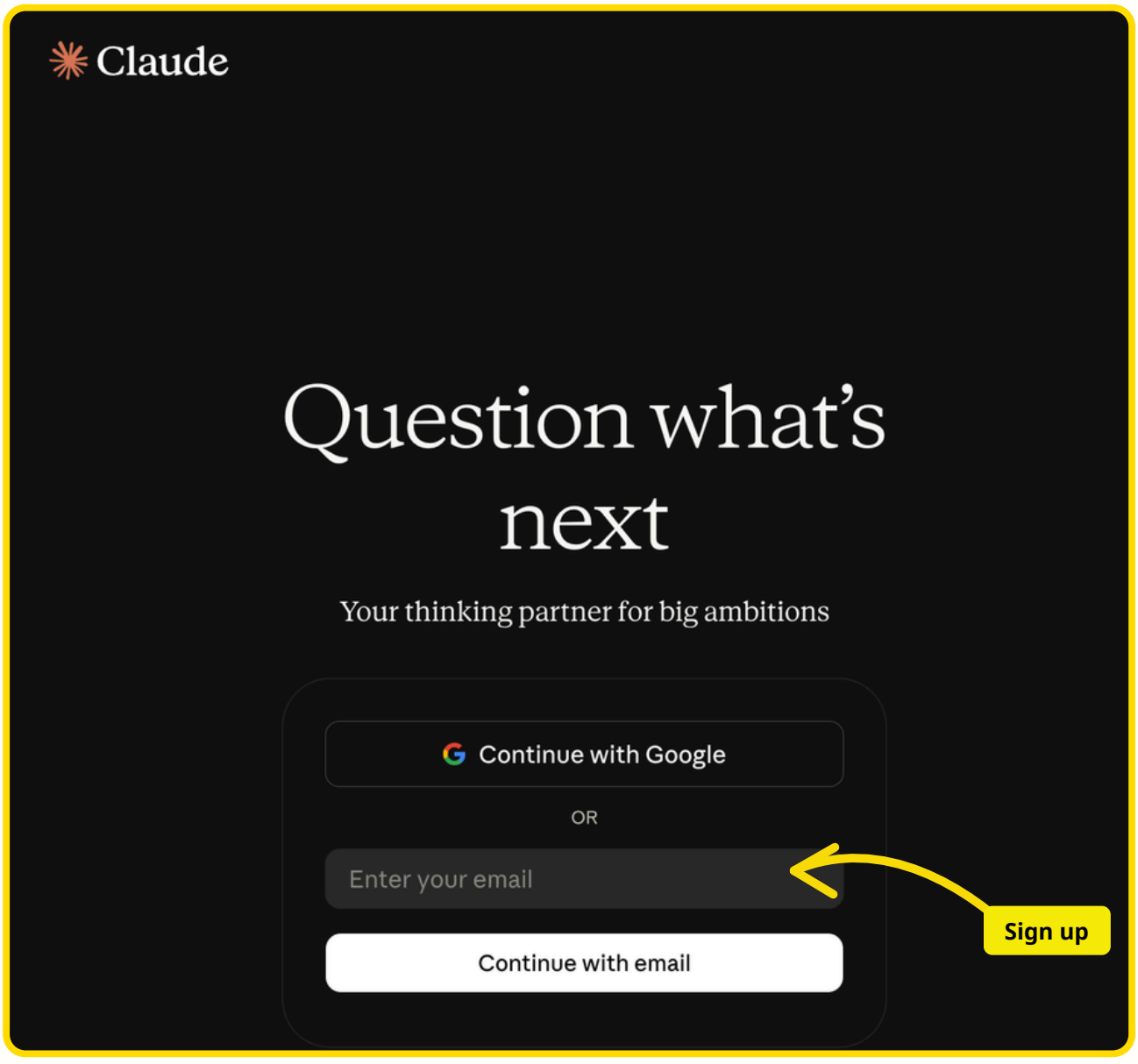
0× coding | **0×** folders

0× No coding knowledge. No folders. If a line can be cut, we cut it.

STEP 1 OF 12

1 Create the Claude account.

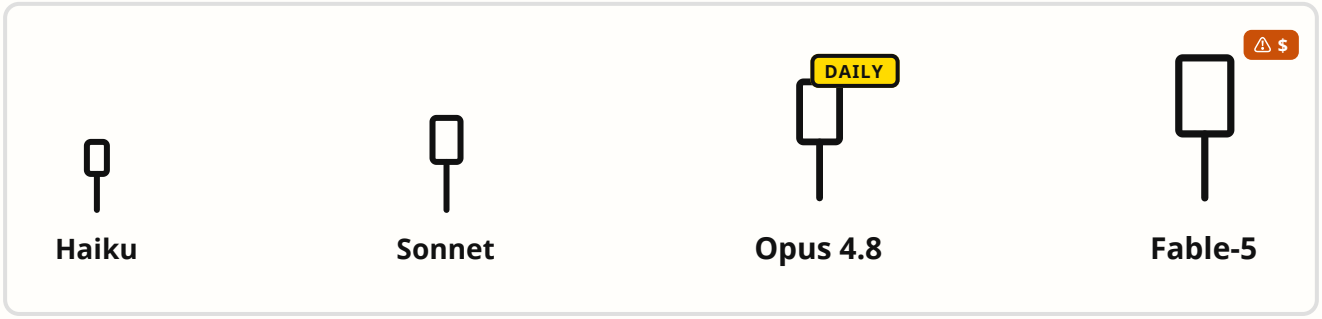
1. Go to **claude.ai**
2. **Sign up with any email.**
3. Verify your **phone number.**



→ ***This is just a start.***

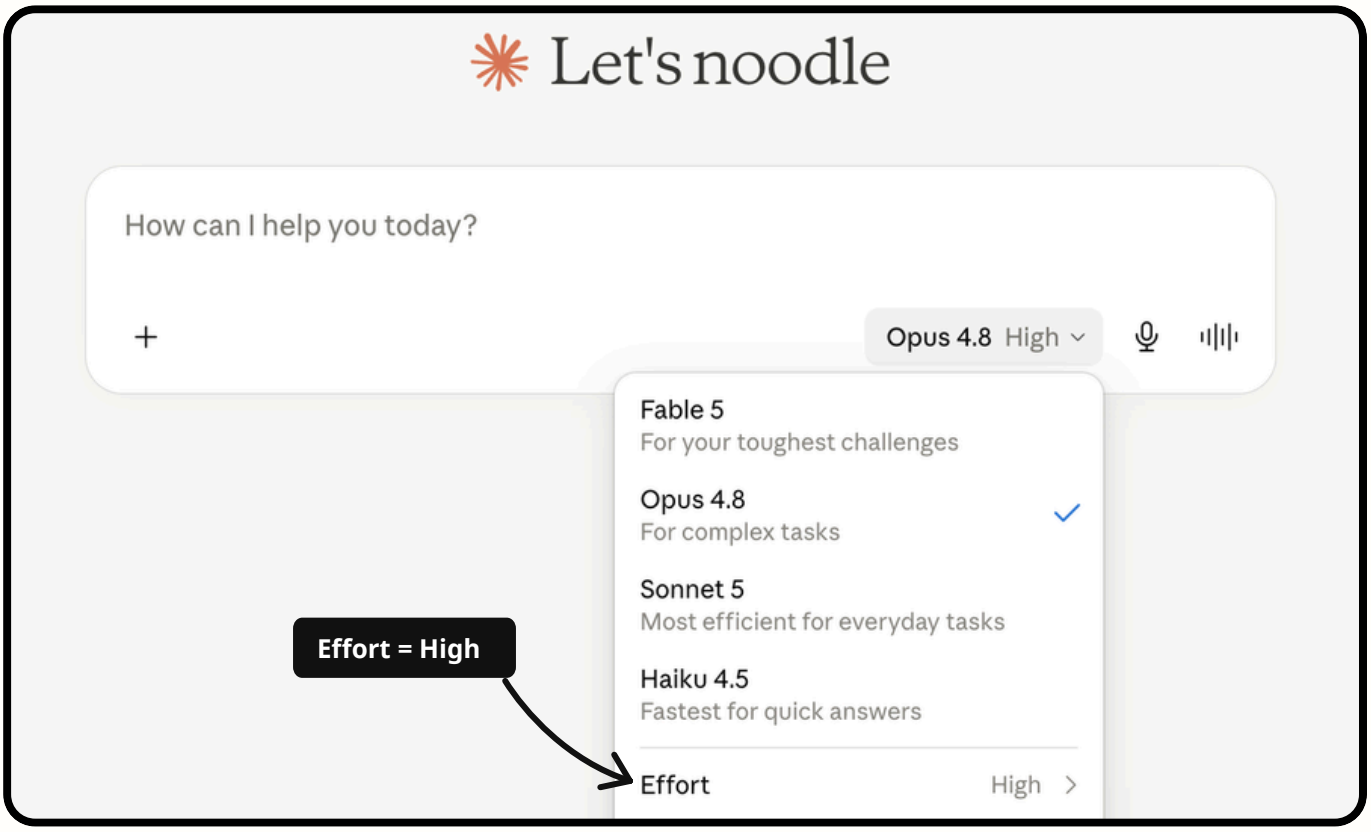
STEP 2 OF 12

2 Pick your model.



For daily work: Opus 4.8 · Effort: High.

1. Look at the **bottom-right corner** of the chat box.
2. Click the **model name.**
3. Select **Opus 4.8**. Set Effort to **High**.



→ ***Fable-5 is the smartest one. It costs extra. Step 6 covers it.***

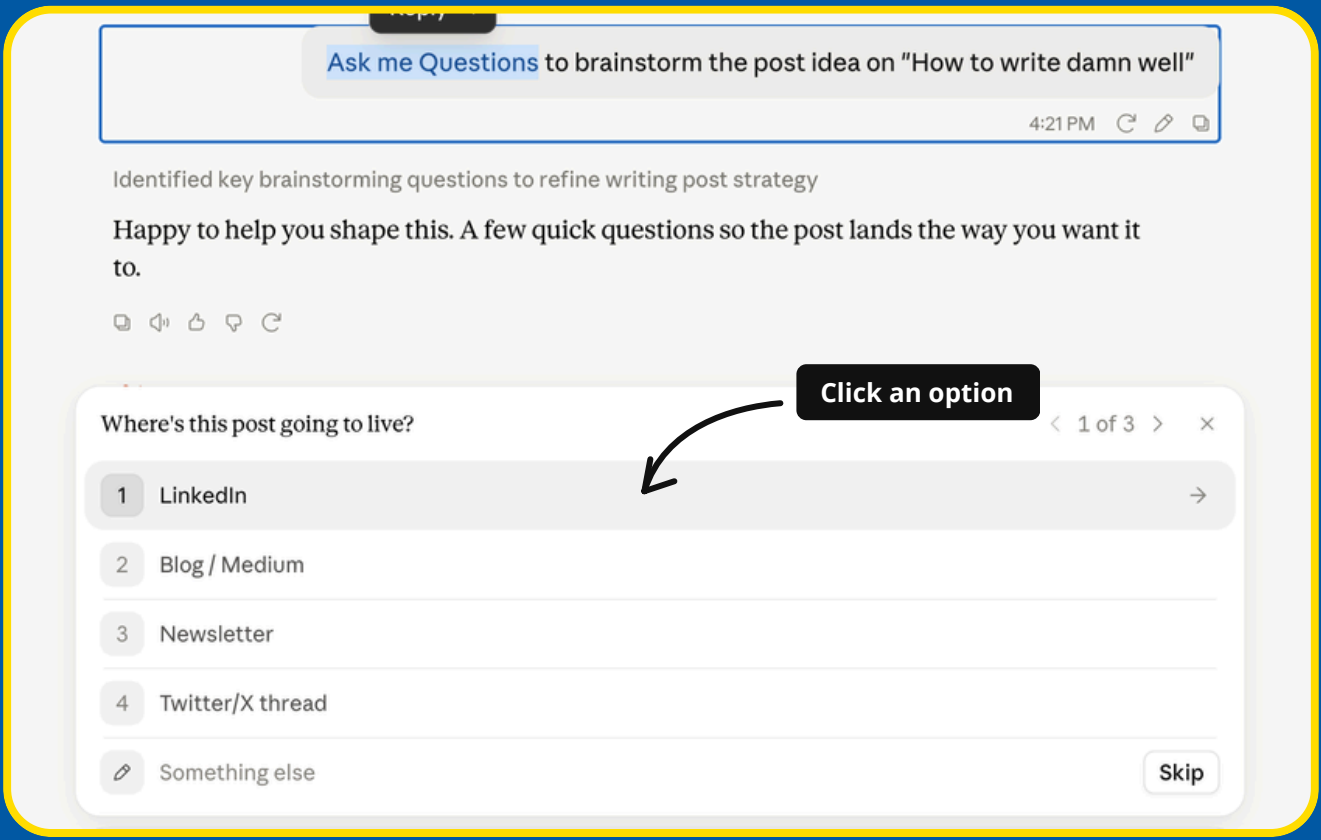
STEP 3 OF 12

3 The magic PROMPT.

End any prompt with five words:

“...ask me questions first.”

1. Type what you want.
2. Add the sentence at the end.
3. Claude asks. You click the answers.



Claude now writes the perfect prompt for you.

Used in every stepfrom here on.

STEP 4 OF 12

4 Give goals. Not tasks.

✗ A TASK

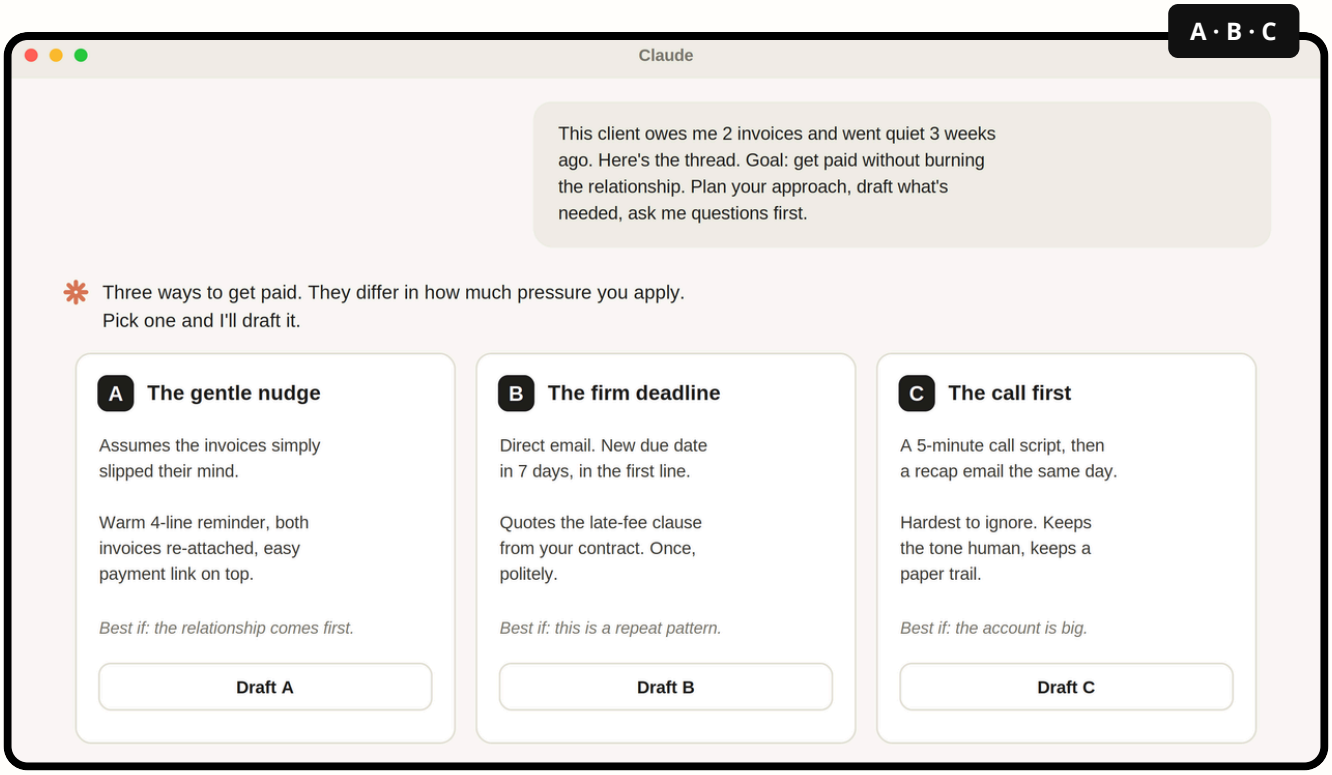
"Write a follow-up email to this client."

✓ A GOAL

"This client owes me 2 invoices and went quiet 3 weeks ago. Here's the thread. Goal: get paid without burning the relationship. Plan your approach, draft what's needed, ask me questions first."

COPY · PASTE TEMPLATE

I need [task] for [goal]. Done means [specific target]. Plan your approach. Ask me questions first.

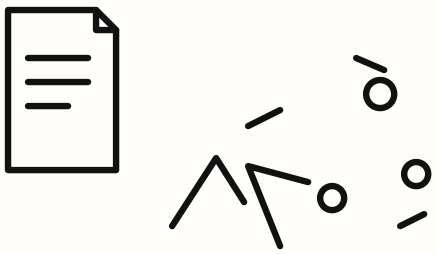


→ ***A task gets you one step. A goal gets you the finished work.***

STEP 5 OF 12

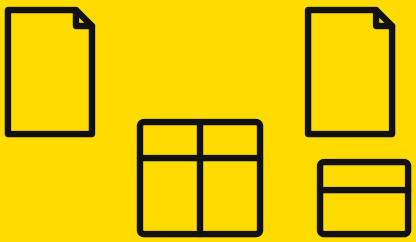
5 One task. One chat.

✗



One Chats. Two half-built things. Parts everywhere.

✓



Two chats. Two finished builds.

New task → New chat.

FINE PRINT

Claude re-reads the entire chat at every turn. Long chats get slower, less accurate, and more expensive.

→ ***Task finished? Open a new chat.***

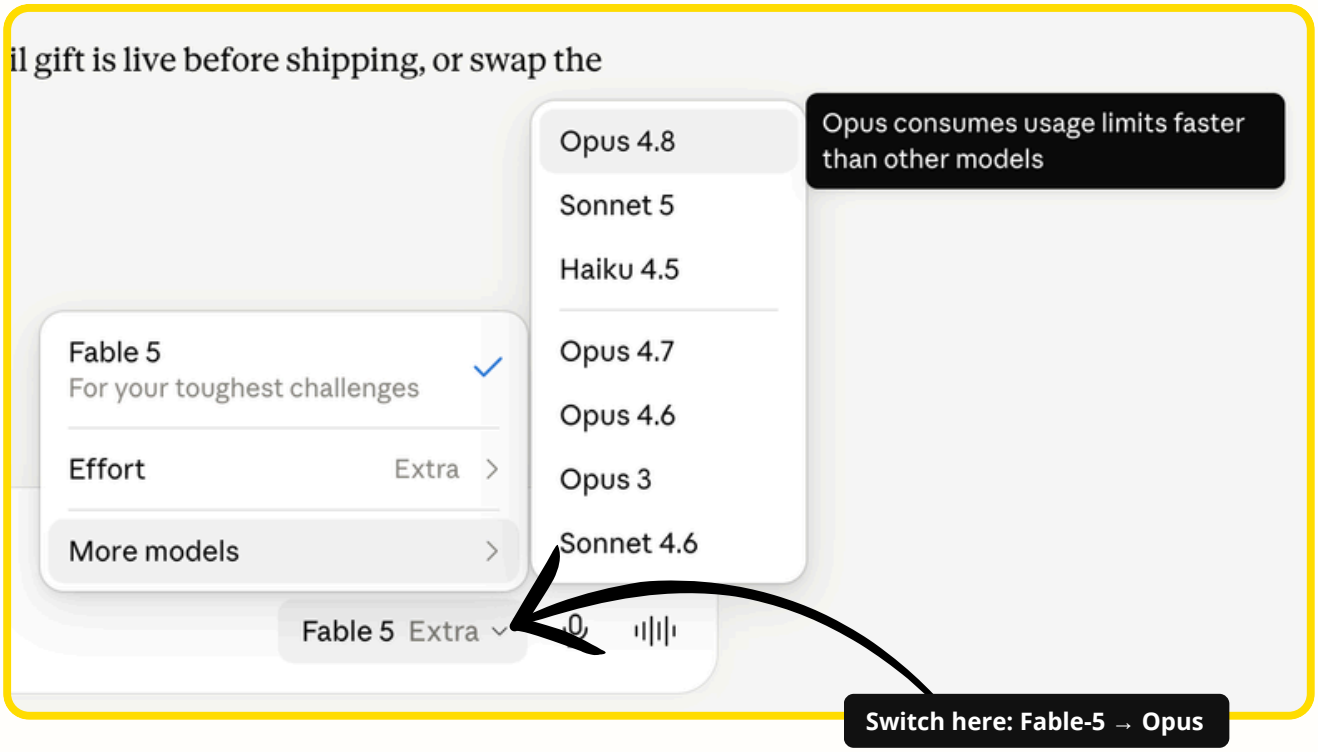
STEP 6 OF 12 · CAUTION

6 ⚠ Fable-5. The expensive one.

The smartest model available. Pay-per-use.

THREE RULES

1. **Hard problems only. Decisions. Strategy. Research.**
2. **One or two turns. Not forty.**
3. **Then switch to Opus 4.8 in the same chat.**



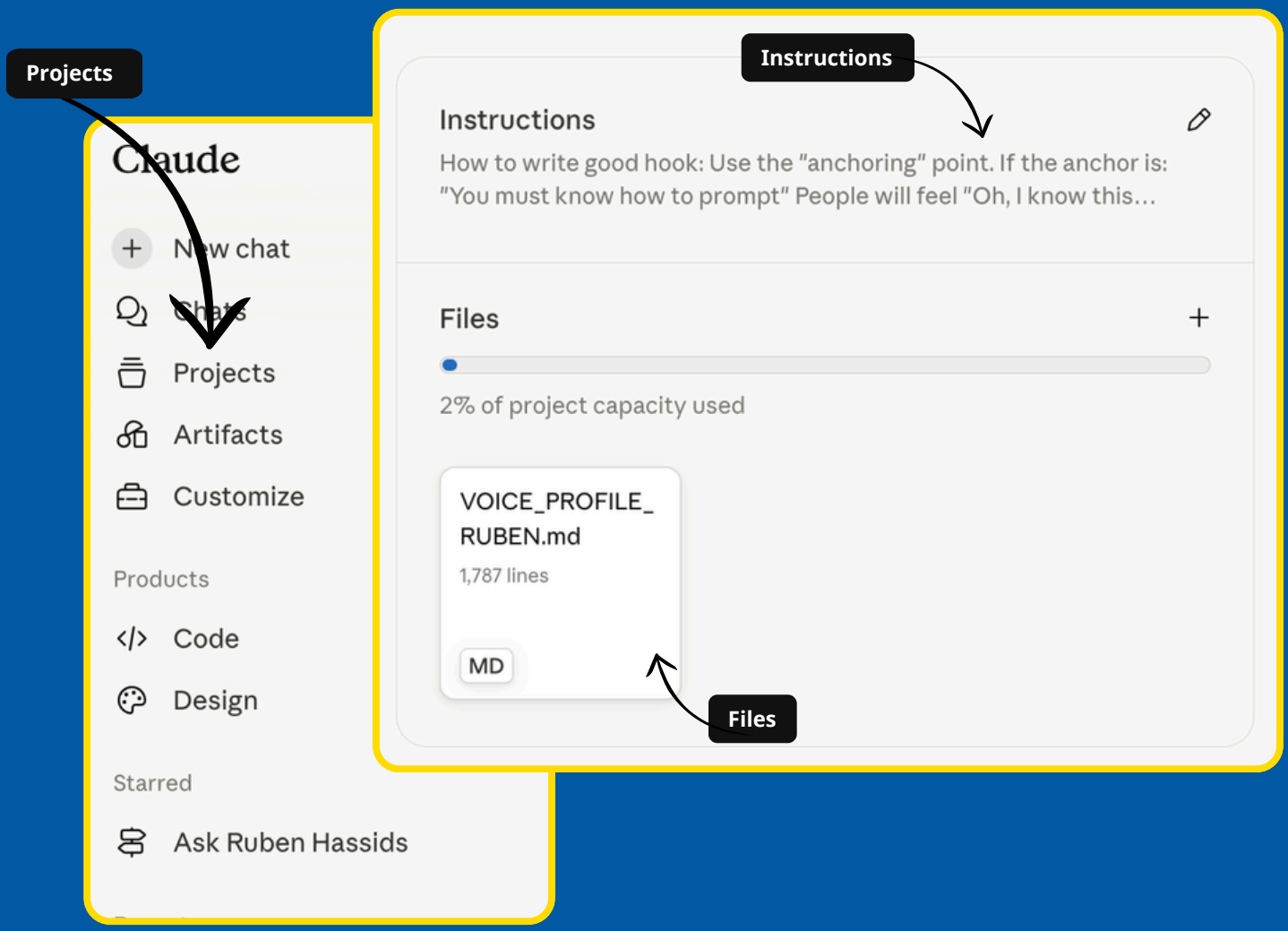
→ *Fable-5 is the senior lawyer. Opus is the intern. The lawyer plans. The intern executes.*

STEP 7 OF 12

7 Create a Project.

A Project is a space inside Claude that remembers your files and instructions across every chat.

1. Left menu → **Projects** → New.
2. Name it after one area of your work. "Client work." "Newsletter."
3. Open **Instructions**. Write how you like things done.



→ ***Every chat inside this Project starts already knowing you.***

STEP 8 OF 12

8 Fill the Project.

Upload three things:

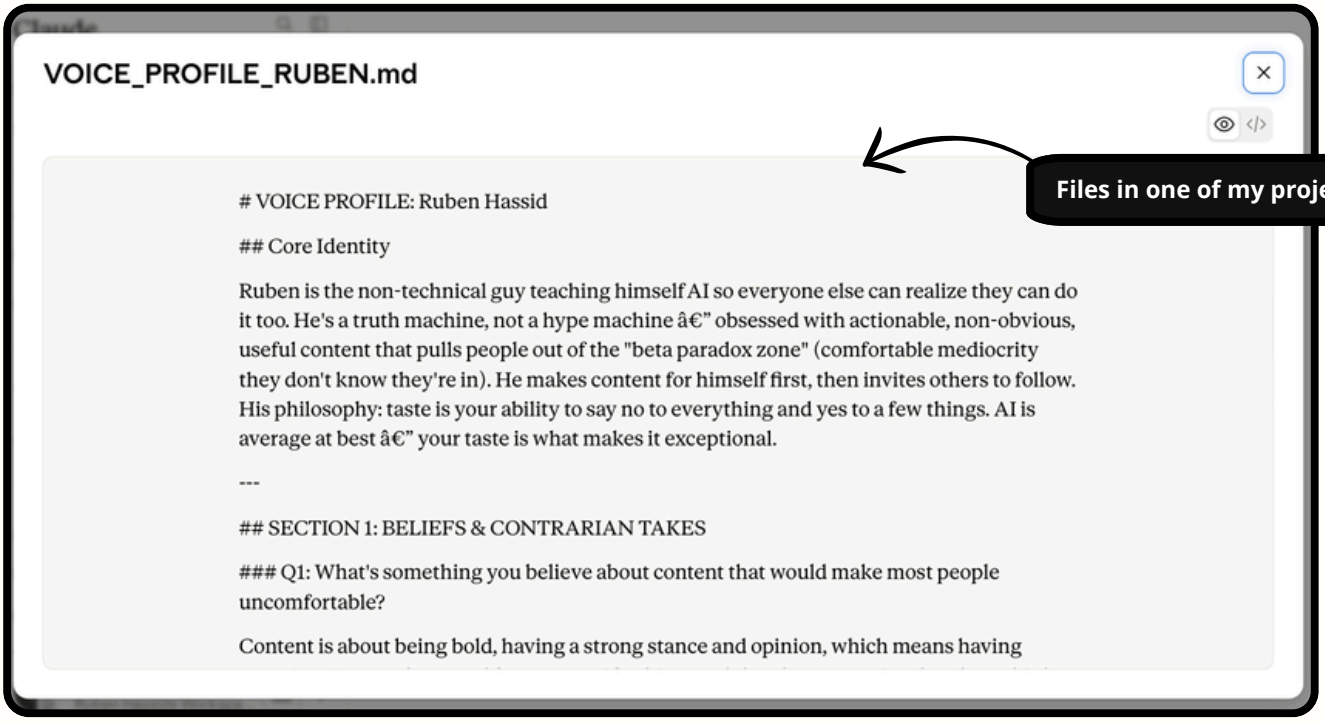
1	3	∞
about-me doc	**writing samples**	**weekly files**
Who you are. What you do. Who you serve.	Examples of your writing.	The files you use every week.

✗ **Retyping your context in every chat.**

✓ **Claude already has it.**

COPY · PASTE — CLAUDE WRITES YOUR ABOUT-ME

Ask me 10 questions about my work, my clients, my goals, and how I like things done. Then write my about-me file. I'll save it in this Project.

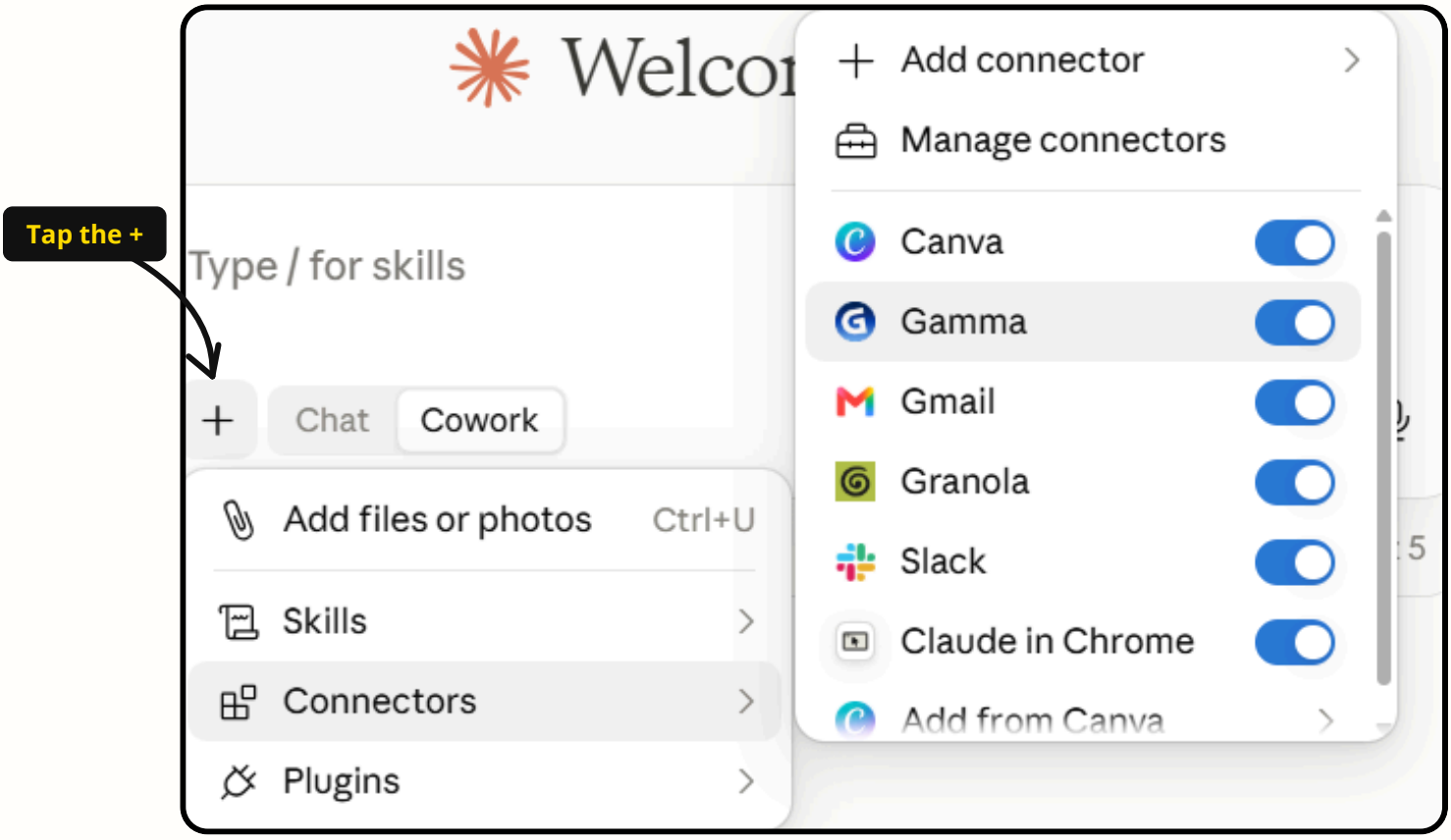


→ ***AI is average by default. Context makes it yours.***

STEP 9 OF 12

9 Connect your apps.

1. Left menu → **Customize** → **Connectors**.
2. Connect **Gmail**. Connect **Calendar**.
3. Use a note-taker (I use Granola)? Connect it too.



TEST IT · COPY · PASTE

Look at my calendar and my inbox. What am I forgetting this week? Ask me questions first.

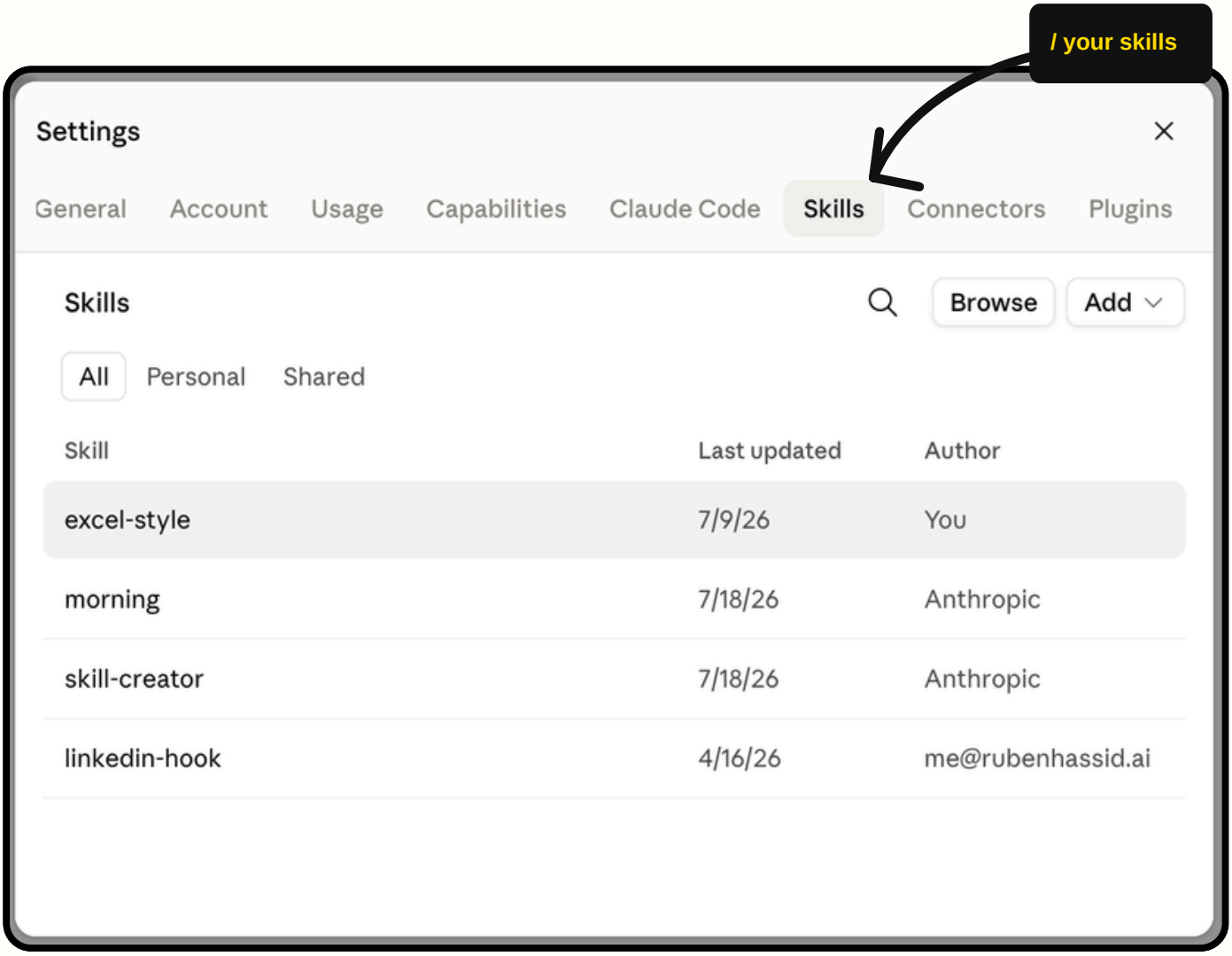
→ ***Claude read the internet. It never read your week. Now it does.***

STEP 10 OF 12

10 Create your first skill.

The rule: explained something to Claude twice? Make it a skill.

1. New chat. Type **/skill-creator**.
2. Describe what you repeat. "Emails my way." "Spreadsheets my way."
3. Answer its questions. Save.
4. From now on: type **/** + the skill name.



→ ***Explain it once. Reuse it forever.***

STEP 11 OF 12

11 Test it. Three real tasks.

From your actual job. Today.

☐ **One decision.**

Help me decide [X]. Stress-test it. Ask me questions first.

☐ **One document.**

Build [the doc you owe someone]. Done means [specific target].
Ask me questions first.

☐ **One mess.**

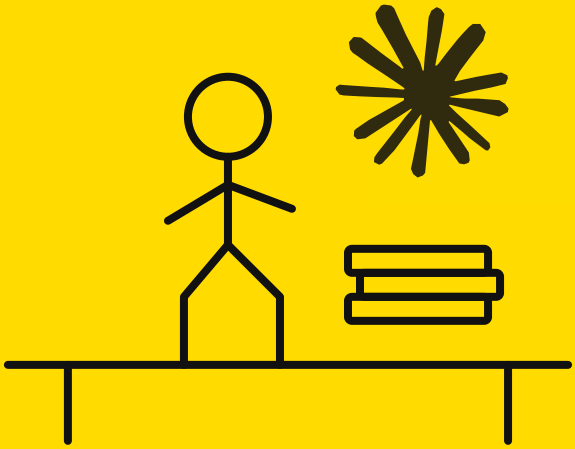
Here's my week — notes, threads, to-dos. Turn it into next week's plan.
Ask me questions first.

✓ **All three worked? Setup complete.**

✗ **One failed? See page 17.**

STEP 12 OF 12

12 Done.



Your Claude is set up.

Estimated time saved: 5 hours / week.

QUICK REFERENCE

Wrong way / right way.

✗ "Write me a report."

✓ **"Goal: [outcome]. Done means [target]."**

✗ Turn 40 of the same chat.

✓ **New task, new chat.**

✗ Fable-5 for an email.

✓ **Fable-5 for the hard decision. Then Opus.**

✗ Retyping your context.

✓ **It lives in the Project.**

✗ "Don't use jargon."

✓ **"Write it so a 16-year-old could read it aloud."**

✗ Guessing the perfect prompt.

✓ **"...ask me questions first."**

 Save this page.

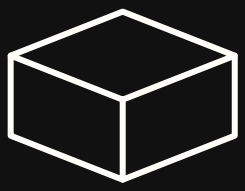
TROUBLESHOOTING

If something failed.

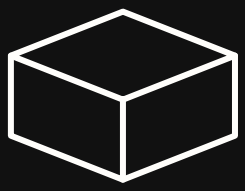
PROBLEM	FIX	STEP
The bill is too high.	Switch back to Opus 4.8 for daily work.	6
Answers feel generic.	Your Project is empty. Fill it.	8
You hit usage limits.	Shorter chats. New chat per task. Full guide: usage-limits newsletter.	—
Something else.	Type ELI5 and describe what happened.	—

Still stuck? There is no step you can't undo. Start a fresh chat and type ELI5 - Claude walks you through it again.

More free guides, same format.



The Claude Certification Playbook



Claude101.com



This guide

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